AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Holden | Model: Holden Commodore | Australian Market Years: 1978-2020
Vehicle Type: Sedan / Wagon / Utility | Segment: Large | Locally Built: Yes
Assembly Plants (AU): Elizabeth, South Australia, Dandenong, Victoria, Pagewood, New South Wales, Acacia

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Holden Commodore was Australia's definitive full-size passenger car, holding the crown as t
he nation's best-selling car for 15 consecutive years (1996-2010). Spanning 16 distinct series
codes across five generations from the original 1978 VB to the billion-dollar Australian-engine
ered VE/VF Zeta platform and the imported European ZB, the Commodore was the family hauler, pol
ice highway patrol interceptor, commercial utility, and Mount Panorama Bathurst racing champion
for over four decades.

First conceived in response to the 1973 oil crisis as a smaller, more fuel-efficient alternativ
e to the full-size Kingswood, Holden heavily re-engineered the German Opel Rekord/Senator body
with 35% heavier structural reinforcement, MacPherson strut front suspension, four-trailing-arm
rear suspension, and Holden's own Red, Blue, and Black sixes and V8s. In 1986, the VL adopted
the high-revving Nissan RB30 3.0L straight-six and legendary Turbo option. The 1988 VN introduc
ed a widened body tailored specifically to Australian shoulder-room expectations and the rugged
Buick-sourced 3.8L V6. The 2006 VE marked a monumental $1.03 billion investment creating the g
lobal GM Zeta rear-wheel-drive platform in Melbourne and Adelaide. The final Australian-built C
ommodore?a Red Hot VF II SS-V Redline sedan?rolled off the Elizabeth line on 20 October 2017.

SERIES / GENERATION: VB (VB Commodore) [1978-1980]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon | ANCAP: None
First Commodore series, launching in October 1978. Won Wheels Car of the Year 1978 for its Euro
pean dynamics, RTS handling, and packaging efficiency.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Red-2850: 2.85L (2848cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 64.0 kW / 198.0 Nm
- Red-3300: 3.3L (3310cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 71.0 kW / 232.0 Nm
- Red-4.2-V8: 4.2L (4146cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 87.0 kW / 271.0 Nm
- Red-5.0-V8: 5.0L (5044cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 114.0 kW / 352.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Commodore Base: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual, Tri-Matic 3-speed automatic, AUD $6513-$7950, F
- Commodore SL: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed manual, Tri-Matic 3-speed automatic, AUD $7250-$8800, Fue
- Commodore SL/E: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=Tri-Matic 3-speed automatic, TH350 3-speed automatic, AUD $1051

Factory Configurations:

* Commodore SL | Sedan | Red-3300 | Tri-Matic 3-speed automatic | RWD | 71.0kW/232.0Nm
* Commodore SL/E | Sedan | Red-5.0-V8 | TH350 3-speed automatic | RWD | 114.0kW/352.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: VL (VL Commodore) [1986-1988]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon | ANCAP: None
Introduced the legendary imported Nissan RB30E 3.0L SOHC inline-six and Garrett water-cooled tu
rbocharged RB30ET, alongside semi-concealed pop-up headlights on Calais and integrated boot spo
iler.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Nissan-RB30E: 3.0L (2962cc) Inline6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 114.0 kW / 247.0 Nm
- Nissan-RB30ET: 3.0L (2962cc) Inline6 (Turbocharged, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 150.0 kW / 296.0 Nm
- Black-5.0-V8-VL: 5.0L (4987cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 122.0 kW / 323.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Commodore Executive: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=5-speed manual (MF5), 4-speed automatic (Jatco 4N71B), AUD
- Commodore Turbo: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=5-speed manual (MF5), 4-speed automatic (Jatco 4N71B), AUD $18
- Calais: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed automatic, AUD $22600-$27800, Fuel=10.8L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Commodore Executive | Sedan | Nissan-RB30E | 4-speed automatic | RWD | 114.0kW/247.0Nm
* Commodore Turbo | Sedan | Nissan-RB30ET | 5-speed manual (MF5) | RWD | 150.0kW/296.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: VN (VN Commodore) [1988-1991]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon, 2-door utility (VG) | ANCAP: None

Major ground-up widening on modified Opel Omega architecture, introducing the Buick 3800 3.8L V
6 and Holden 5.0L EFI V8, and resurrecting the Holden Ute as the VG in 1990. Won 1988 Wheels CO
TY.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Buick-3800-LN3: 3.8L (3791cc) V6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 125.0 kW / 292.0 Nm
- Holden-5000i-V8: 5.0L (4987cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 165.0 kW / 385.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Executive: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=5-speed manual (T5), 4-speed automatic (TH700-R4), AUD $20014-$24500
- SS: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=5-speed manual (T5), 4-speed automatic (TH700), AUD $27500-$31200, Fuel=12.

Factory Configurations:

* Executive | Sedan | Buick-3800-LN3 | 4-speed automatic (TH700-R4) | RWD | 125.0kW/292.0Nm
* SS | Sedan | Holden-5000i-V8 | 5-speed manual (T5) | RWD | 165.0kW/385.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: VT (VT Commodore) [1997-2000]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door wagon | ANCAP: 3 Stars

Round aero styling that became Australia’s all-time record-selling car series (303,895 units).

Standard independent rear suspension (IRS), traction control, and in Series II (1999) debuted t
he imported all-alloy Gen III LS1 5.7L Chevrolet V8.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Ecotec-3800: 3.8L (3791cc) V6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 147.0 kW / 304.0 Nm
- Supercharged-Ecotec-L67: 3.8L (3791cc) V6 (Supercharged, Petrol (Premium Unleaded)) | 171.0 kW / 375.
- Holden-5.0L-VT-I: 5.0L (4987cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 179.0 kW / 400.0 Nm
- Gen-III-LS1: 5.7L (5665cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Premium Unleaded)) | 220.0 kW / 446.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Executive: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=5-speed manual (Getrag 260), 4-speed automatic (4L60-E), AUD $29760-
- Acclaim: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed automatic (4L60-E), AUD $33900-$38500, Fuel=10.2L/100km
- SS: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=5-speed/6-speed manual (T56), 4-speed automatic (4L60-E), AUD $39990-$44800

Factory Configurations:

* Executive | Sedan | Ecotec-3800 | 4-speed automatic (4L60-E) | RWD | 147.0kW/304.0Nm
* SS | Sedan | Gen-III-LS1 | 6-speed manual (T56) | RWD | 220.0kW/446.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: VE (VE Commodore (Series I & II)) [2006-2013]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door Sportwagon, 2-door utility | ANCAP: 5 Stars

Billion-dollar clean-sheet Australian engineering masterpiece. Ground-up rear-wheel-drive Zeta architecture with 50:50 weight distribution, near-zero front overhang, 5-star ANCAP rating, and exported to the US as the Pontiac G8.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Alloytec-3.6: 3.6L (3564cc) V6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 180.0 kW / 330.0 Nm
- SIDI-3.6-LLT: 3.6L (3564cc) V6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 210.0 kW / 350.0 Nm
- Gen-IV-L98-6.0: 6.0L (5967cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Premium Unleaded)) | 270.0 kW / 530.0
- Gen-IV-L77-6.0: 6.0L (5967cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol / E85 Ethanol) | 270.0 kW / 530.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Omega: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=4-speed auto (4L60-E), 6-speed auto (6L45), AUD $34490-$41500, Fuel=10.9
- SV6: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=6-speed manual (Aisin AY6), 5-speed/6-speed auto, AUD $39990-$45500, Fuel=
- SS / SS V: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=6-speed manual (Tremec T56 / TR-6060), 6-speed automatic (6L80-E), A

Factory Configurations:

* SV6 | Sedan | SIDI-3.6-LLT | 6-speed automatic (6L45) | RWD | 210.0kW/350.0Nm
* SS V Redline | Sedan | Gen-IV-L77-6.0 | 6-speed manual (TR-6060) | RWD | 270.0kW/530.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: VF (VF Commodore (Series I & II)) [2013-2017]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 5-door Sportwagon, 2-door utility | ANCAP: 5 Stars

The ultimate Australian-engineered automobile. Lightweight aluminium bonnet and bootlid, Head-Up Display, automatic parking assist, and in 2015 Series II introduced the thunderous Corvette 6.2L LS3 V8 (304kW/570Nm). The final car built at Elizabeth SA on 20 October 2017.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- SIDI-3.0-LFW: 3.0L (2997cc) V6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 185.0 kW / 290.0 Nm
- SIDI-3.6-LFX: 3.6L (3564cc) V6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 210.0 kW / 350.0 Nm
- Gen-IV-L77-6.0-VF: 6.0L (5967cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol / E85) | 270.0 kW / 530.0 Nm
- Gen-IV-LS3-6.2: 6.2L (6162cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Premium 98 RON)) | 304.0 kW / 570.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Evoke: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=6-speed automatic (6L45), AUD $34990-$39500, Fuel=8.3L/100km
- SV6: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=6-speed manual, 6-speed automatic, AUD $35990-$42000, Fuel=9.0L/100km
- SS V Redline: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=6-speed manual (TR-6060), 6-speed automatic (6L80-E with paddle s

Factory Configurations:

* SS V Redline | Sedan | Gen-IV-LS3-6.2 | 6-speed manual (Tremec TR-6060) | RWD | 304.0kW/570.0Nm
* SV6 | Sportwagon | SIDI-3.6-LFX | 6-speed automatic | RWD | 210.0kW/350.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: ZB (ZB Commodore) [2018-2020]

Body Styles: 5-door liftback, Sportwagon, Tourer high-ride crossover | ANCAP: 5 Stars

Imported from Opel in Ruesselsheim, Germany. Front-wheel-drive and Twinster all-wheel-drive with 2.0L Turbo petrol, 2.0L Turbo Diesel, and 235kW 3.6L LGX V6 mated to a 9-speed automatic.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- GM-LTG-2.0T: 2.0L (1998cc) Inline4 (Turbocharged, Petrol (Premium Unleaded)) | 191.0 kW / 350.0 Nm
- GM-LGX-3.6-V6: 3.6L (3649cc) V6 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol (Unleaded)) | 235.0 kW / 381.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- LT: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=9-speed automatic, AUD $33690-$38000, Fuel=7.4L/100km
- VXR: Drivetrain=AWD, Trans=9-speed automatic, AUD $55990-$58000, Fuel=9.3L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* RS | 5-door liftback | GM-LTG-2.0T | 9-speed automatic | FWD | 191.0kW/350.0Nm

* VXR | 5-door liftback | GM-LGX-3.6-V6 | 9-speed automatic | AWD | 235.0kW/381.0Nm